JAMESCLEMENT ONYEKACHI UGWU

Health Economics | Epidemiology and Public Health | Malaria, Trachoma and NTDs |
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE:

I am a health economist and early-career interdisciplinary researcher bridging epidemiology, disease control, and data science to minimize healthcare burdens for vulnerable groups, including women, children, internally displaced persons (IDPs), the elderly, and people with disabilities. Serving as a primary investigator for an RSTMH/CIFF-funded grant, I recently completed a randomized controlled trial analyzing the time-to-relapse of trachoma after treatment, evaluating the clinical and economic efficacy of compared antibiotics. My research trajectory is currently focused primarily on malaria control through the integration of artificial intelligence and satellite climate data, with a secondary focus on trachoma and other vector-borne neglected tropical diseases (NTDs). My work combines AI-driven vector surveillance with automated engineering solutions to drastically reduce household out-of-pocket health expenditures and minimize state financial burdens. Guided by my RETIRE framework in research, I focus on building resilient, cost-effective health systems, dreaming about a tropical Africa where no mother or child suffers or is impoverished by a disease we already know how to control, because effective care means availability, affordability and accessibility for all.

Research Philosophy: I believe that rigorous research should extend beyond academic publication to strengthen institutions, foster transparency and accountability, improve lives, and advance sustainable development, so my work is guided by RETIRE, a self-developed framework prioritising Rigorous, Evidence-driven, Transparent, Impact-Oriented, Reproducible, and Ethically responsible research. The framework aligns with UNESCO's open science principles to guarantee robust and universally accessible scientific outcomes.

EDUCATION

SOUTH DAKOTA STATE UNIVERSITY (SDSU). **Brookings, USA.**
Programme: *Masters of Sciences (M.Sc.), Economics.* (admitted 2025; entry deferred).
Specialization: General Economics (major).
Minors: Health, and Econometrics.

Research Assistantship Award Recipient

- Admitted to the M.Sc. Economics programme
- Awarded a competitive Research Assistantship
- Programme Start deferred

UNIVERSITY OF NIGERIA, NSUKKA (UNN). **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Programme: *Bachelor of Sciences (B.Sc.), Economics.* (2016-2020-21).
Qualification/Honours: *Upper Second (Magna cum Laude)* June 2021.
Selected Coursework: Mathematical Economics, Statistics, Applied Statistics & Econometrics, Advanced Statistics & Econometrics, Computing Applications for Economists, Business Finance, Business mgmt. Accounting, Research Methods & Development Economics.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE AND INNOVATION PROJECTS

A. Collaborative Grants & Funded Research Projects.

1. Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH) and CIFF Partnership Funding. **London, United Kingdom.**
Principal Investigator | 2024 Early Career Grant Awardee. Dec 2024 – Mar 2026.
Project: *Durational Evaluation of Randomized Controlled Trial (RCT) Outcomes on Trachoma Treatment and Relapse: A Study of the Largest Urban Slum in Enugu-State, Nigeria*

- Awarded £ 4996.00 (British Pounds) by RSTMH in partnership with the Children's Investment Fund Foundation (CIFF).
- Conducted quantitative evaluation of treatment efficacy and time-to-relapse by comparing WHO-recommended antibiotics (Zithromax) with other locally affordable and accessible antibiotics (Zolon and CETROXOL).
- Applied survival analysis techniques, including Kaplan-Meier estimation and log-rank testing, to evaluate relapse-free survival.

Methods/Tools: Survival Analysis| Clinical Trial Analysis |Biostatistics

2. Collaborative Grant Proposal: Molecular Mechanisms of Liposomal Harmine-Induced Apoptosis in Triple-Negative Breast Cancer. December, 2025.
Co-Author & Methodology Co-Designer | Collaborative Research Proposal. **China.**

- Contributed to the development of a collaborative funding proposal submitted to Xinjiang Medical University.
- Developed the Research Questions, Aim, and Objectives and also designed the Methodological components for investigating molecular mechanisms through Western blot and RT-PCR analysis.
- Awarded CNY¥ 70,000.00 (Chinese Yuan) grant for the research and in-vitro experiment and analysis.

Methods: Research Design | Methodology Development | Biomedical Research Collaboration.

RESEARCH OUTPUTS AND SCHORLARLY CONTRIBUTIONS

Peer-reviewed Publications.

1. **British Medical Journal (BMJ):** *Household Living Conditions and Food Insecurity in Nigeria: A Longitudinal Study During Covid-19 Pandemic* (2022) – https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2022-066810

Registered Protocols and Pre-prints (2026)

1. Durational Efficacy and Relapse of Ocular Chlamydia trachomatis Infection in Children: A Randomized Controlled Trial of Pfizer's Zithromax Versus Alternative Azithromycin Formulations in Enugu, Nigeria **Protocol: Registered on**
2. Evaluating International Research Partnerships on AI-Driven Anti-Malarial Resistance Surveillance in Tropical Africa: A Quantitative Scientometric Analysis of Post-2020 Publications. |**Registered in OSF: https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/U38N5**

Protocols and Manuscripts Under Review

1. mHealth-Enhanced vs Traditional Prenatal Care in Rural Sub-Saharan Africa: A Meta-analysis of Randomized Controlled Trials from the COVID-19 Era. | Protocol Registered on Prospero | https://www.crd.york.ac.uk/PROSPERO/view/CRD420251235925.
2. The Linkages of Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) Deficiencies to Antimicrobial Resistance in Trachoma Control: Cross-sectional Multinomial Regression Analysis in a Low-Resource Setting.

B.Sc. Dissertation |Open Source (Available on Academia & ResearchGate)

1. Climate change and Agricultural Productivity Nexus: An ARDL (Autoregressive Distributed Lag Model) Approach. | Available on: https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.15361.33121 | *Also Available on Academia Database*

Policy Briefs

Strengthening Trachoma Control in Enugu State: Evidence-Based Policy Recommendations from a Randomized Controlled Trial - Submitted to: Enugu State Ministry of Health, Enugu State Ministry of Budget and Planning, National Population Commission, Enugu-State Office and Enugu-State Waste Management Authority (ESWAMA).

Technical Reports

Grant Technical Report (approximately 80 pages) on Durational Evaluation of Randomized Controlled Trial Outcomes on Trachoma Treatment and Relapse. For (the Awarding Institution & the Funding Institution):

- Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH).
- Children's Investment Fund Foundation (CIFF)

WORK AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ICERP (Independent Centre for Experiments, Research, and Programmes) **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Founder/Lead Researcher. March 2023 – Present

- Guided 30+ M.Sc. and Ph.D. students on research conceptualization, methodology design, and data analysis working with researchers and scholars of varying ranks across academic institutions.
- Lead a small team of young scholars constituting the not-for-profit small-scale think tank, offering independent research services and grant proposals writing for solving public health and socio-economic issues.

National Accounts, Energy and Environmental Statistics Division (NAESSD),
National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Graduate Special Assistant to Chief Economist & National Youth Service Corp (NYSC) Nov. 2021 – Feb. 2023.

- Successfully collated the statutory allocation and internally generated revenue of states in Nigeria.
- Successfully contributed to the retrieval of institutional periodic data from public parastatals in Abuja.
- Collaborated and partook in data outsourcing, surveys, and field trips to different states for data collection.

PARG, (Policy Analysis and Research Group) UNN **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Director of Research and Academic Planning (DRAP; elected) July 2019- August 2021

- Organized annual parliamentary policy debate, developed, and managed PARG's E-library and media repository.
- Mentored enthusiastic analysts, organized intra-university field trip,
- Successfully directed over 40 research projects and their subsequent official presentations.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Happy End Academy, Odim Gate, UNN. **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Pre-College Tutor [Economics, English Language]. March 2017 – July, 2021.
• Consistently improved the performances of over 65% of students in their external tests.
*Team Lead, **Academic Tutorials, UNN.*** April 2017 – June 2021, **Enugu, Nigeria.**

- Personally reviewed, summarized and developed revision questions from 7 General Studies' (GS) courses for all students of UNN.
- Led a 4-man team that periodically organize and teach core courses in tutorials for school mates [**Applied Computing to Economics, Econometrics, Advanced Statistics, & Intermediate Micro & Macro-Economics**]
- Successfully organized and mobilized funds for fees and tuitions of indigent and bereaved course mates.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- **Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH – 0025349)** **London, UK.**
- **Policy Analysis and Research Group** *(PARG Senior-ranking member)* **Nigeria**
- **Data Science Nigeria (DSN)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Statistical Association (NSA)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Economic Society (NES)** - **Nigeria**
- **Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) –** *(Digital member, not a charter holder)* **Nigeria.**

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND EVENTS.

- **PARG | Mastering the Art of Impactful Presentations & Data-driven Insights.** **Virtual,** October 5 – 7, 2023.
  A Comprehensive Workshop on Slides, Delivery, and Econometrics Analysis Guest Technical Facilitator.
- **Talk with Becky Podcast |** The Impact of Economic Policies on Social Inequality. **Guest Expert,** Dec. 24, 2024.
- **RSTMH | Global Research in Progress Webinar, (Colloquium).** **Virtual, June 2025.**
- **Delegate, National Youth Confab.** October 7 – 8, 2026.

- **RSTMH | Annual General Meeting & Grants Workshop.** **London, United Kingdom**.
  Equitable Partnerships in Global Health October 15 – 17, 2026.
- **CFA Institute Webinar:** Harnessing AI for smarter Investment Decisions. Apr 24, 2025.

SKILLS, INTERESTS, AND AWARDS

Econometrics: a) Linear Regression (OLS, ARDL, and Panel-Data) Analysis. b) Logistic Regression Analysis (Binary, Ordered, and Multinomial Logit) models. c) Duration Models (Count Model analysis, Negative Binomial, and Survival Analysis.

Data Analysis & Programming: a) Stata b) SPSS c) E-views d) R f) Python g) Google Earth h) MS-Office tools, etc.

Evidence Synthesis: a) Systematic Reviews b) Meta-Analysis c) Scoping Reviews d) Bibliographical and Scientometric Analysis e) Prisma and Frameworks Reporting.

Other soft skills: Leadership, Critical Thinking, Human management, Emotional Intelligence, Negotiation skills, Communication skills, Analytical and business skills, Logic & Philosophy, Script Writing, and Sales.

Interests: • Entrepreneurship • Football, • Travelling • Artificial Intelligence (AI) Creation • Social Media • Music and • News.

Merit Awards (12+):

• Best Researcher [Policy Analysis and Research Group - 2021].
• Leadership Excellence [PARG, 2021].
• Leadership Excellence [SBL, 2021].
• Most Resourceful member [PARG – 2021]
• Excellence for Selfless Service [UNN, 2021]
• Best Policy Debater [PARG & NESA, 2018-2020]. etc.,

REFEREES

Available on Request.